

LUZULA

is a slow-growing, evergreen, spreading, rhizomatous, perennial grass. H to 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Produces thick tufts of broad, hairy-edged, mid-green leaves, with white margins. Leafy stems bear terminal, open, brown flower spikes in summer. Tolerates shade; suitable for woodland gardens. Z3–8

LYCASTE

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
L. cruenta (illus. p.467). Vigorous, deciduous, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H and S 1½ft (45cm). Fragrant, triangular, green-and-yellow flowers, 2in (5cm) across, are produced singly in spring. Has broadly ovate, ribbed, soft leaves, to 1ft (30cm) long. Grow in partial shade during summer and avoid spraying, which can mark leaves. Z11–12 (min. 52°F/11°C; max. 86°F/30°C)

LYCHNIS

CARYOPHYLLACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals, biennials, and perennials. Fully hardy. Require a wide range of soil-types, from dry to wet, also sunny to partially shaded positions. Propagate by division or seed in fall or spring.
L. ‘Abbotswood Rose’. See *L. x walkeri* ‘Abbotswood Rose’.
L. alpina, syn. *Viscaria alpina* (Alpine catchfly). Tuft-forming perennial. H and S to 6in (15cm). Has dense tufts of thick, linear, deep green leaves. In summer, sticky stems each bear a rounded head of pale to deep pink or, rarely, white flowers with spreading, frilled petals. Suits a rock garden. Z3–8
L. chalconica illus. p.235.
L. coeli-rosa. See *Silene coeli-rosa*.
L. coronaria illus. p.268. ‘**Alba**’, H 32in (80cm), S 18in (45cm), is a clump-forming perennial, often grown as a biennial. From mid-to late summer, produces white flowers in panicles on branched, gray stems, above gray leaves. Z4–8
L. flos-jovis illus. p.265.
L. x haageana, syn. *L. x haagena*. Short-lived, clump-forming perennial. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Clusters of large, 5-petaled, white, orange, or red flowers are borne in summer. Ovate leaves are mid-green. Best raised regularly from seed. Z5–8
L. x haageana. See *L. x haageana*.
L. viscaria. Clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). From early to midsummer, rather sticky, star-shaped, reddish-purple flowers are borne in dense clusters above narrowly ovate to oblong, dark green leaves. Suitable for the front of a border or a rock garden. Z5–8. ‘**Splendens Plena**’ illus. p.265.
L. x walkeri ‘Abbotswood Rose’, syn. *L. ‘Abbotswood Rose’*. Neat, clump-forming perennial. H 12–15in (30–38cm), S 9in (23cm). Has ovate, gray leaves and gray, branching stems that, from mid-to late summer, bear sprays of rounded, 5-petaled, bright rose-pink flowers. Z6–9

LYCIANTHES

SOLANACEAE

Genus of perennials and shrubs grown mainly for their attractive flowers, also sometimes for their colored or variegated foliage. Commonly grown in containers for summer bedding; also good for borders. Half hardy. Needs a sunny site in moist, but not wet, fertile soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed sown in fall or spring.
L. rantonnetii, syn. *Solanum rantonnei*, *S. rantonnetti* (Blue potato bush). Lax, evergreen shrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Has ovate to lance-shaped, often wavy-margined, mid- to deep green leaves. In summer and fall, bears clusters of shallowly trumpet-shaped, dark blue to violet-blue flowers, to 1in (2.5cm) across, with paler blue or yellow-tinged centers, followed by ovoid red fruits. Z9–11. ‘**Royal Robe**’ illus. p.310.

LYCIUM

SOLANACEAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs, sometimes with long, scandent branches, grown for their habit, flowers, and fruits. Useful for poor, dry soil and coastal gardens. May be grown as a hedge. Fully hardy to frost tender. Prefers full sun and not too rich, well-drained soil. Remove dead wood in winter and cut back to restrict growth if necessary. Cut back hedges hard in spring. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer, by seed in fall, or by hardwood cuttings in winter.
L. barbarum, syn. *L. halimifolium* (Chinese box thorn, Duke of Argyll’s tea-tree). Deciduous, arching, often spiny shrub. H 11½ft (3.5m), S 15ft (5m). Lance-shaped leaves are bright green or gray-green. In late spring and summer, produces funnel-shaped, purple or pink flowers, followed by spherical, orange-red berries. Z5–9
L. halimifolium. See *L. barbarum*.

LYCORIS

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of late summer- and early fall-flowering bulbs with showy flower heads on leafless stems. Frost hardy to half hardy; in cool areas is best grown in containers or planted in greenhouse borders. Needs sun, well-drained soil, and a warm period in summer to ripen bulbs so they flower. Provide regular liquid feed while in growth. After summer dormancy, water from early fall until following summer, when foliage dies away. Propagate by seed when ripe or in spring or summer or by off-sets in late summer.
L. aurea (Golden spider lily). Late summer- and early fall-flowering bulb. H to 2ft (60cm), S to 8in (20cm). Produces a head of 5 or 6 bright yellow flowers that have narrow, reflexed petals, with very wavy margins, and conspicuous stamens. Strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves emerge after flowering. Z10–11
L. radiata (Red spider lily) illus. p.410.
L. squamigera (Resurrection lily). Late summer- or early fall-flowering bulb. H 18–28in (45–70cm), S 1ft (30cm). Bears a head of 6–8 fragrant, funnel-shaped,

rose-pink flowers, 4in (10cm) long, with reflexed petal tips. Strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves form after flowers. Z10–11

LYGODIUM

LYGODIACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen, climbing ferns, usually with 2 kinds of fronds: vegetative and fertile. Half hardy to frost tender. Requires shade or partial shade and humus-rich, moist, peaty soil. Best grown among shrubby plants that can provide support. Plants grown under glass in containers need support. Remove faded fronds regularly. Propagate by division in spring or by fresh spores in summer.
L. japonicum (Japanese climbing fern). Deciduous, climbing fern. H 6ft (2m), S indefinite. Mid-green fronds consist of delicate, finger-shaped pinnae; fertile fronds are broader and 3–5 lobed, with a longer, terminal lobe. Z11–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

LYONIA

ERICACEAE

Genus of deciduous and evergreen shrubs, sometimes small trees, grown for their racemes of urn-shaped flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Needs full or partial shade and moist, peaty, acid soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.
L. ligustrina. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Ovate, dark green leaves set off dense racemes of globular urn-shaped, white flowers from mid- to late summer. Z7–9
L. ovateifolia. Deciduous or semi-evergreen, bushy shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 6ft (2m). Produces red shoots and ovate, dark green leaves. Racemes of urn-shaped, white flowers are borne in late spring and early summer. Z6–8

LYONOTHAMNUS

ROSACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen tree, grown for its foliage and flowers. Frost hardy. Needs sun or partial shade, a warm, sheltered position, and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.
L. floribundus (Catalina ironwood). **subsp. aspleniifolius**. Evergreen, slender tree. H 40ft (12m), S 20ft (6m), has rather stringy, reddish-brown bark and much divided, fernlike, dark green leaves. Large, flattened heads of 5-petaled, star-shaped white flowers are produced in early summer. Z8–10

LYSICHITON

ARACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, marginal water plants and bog plants, grown for their handsome spathes and very large, glossy foliage. Fully hardy. Prefers full sun, but tolerates partial shade. Tolerates both still and running water. Propagate by seed sown when fresh, in late summer.
L. americanum. See *L. americanus*.
L. americanus, syn. *L. americanum*, illus. p.444.
L. camtschatsensis illus. p.434.

LYSIMACHIA

Loosestrife

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, herbaceous, and evergreen perennials and shrubs, suitable for the border or rock garden. Fully to frost tender. Prefers a sunny or partially shaded position and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.
L. ciliata ‘Firecracker’. Erect, clump-forming perennial. H 20–36in (50–90m), S 4–20in (10–50cm). Slender stems bear solitary or paired, slightly pendent, star-shaped, yellow flowers, with small, reddish brown centers, in summer. Ovate to lance-shaped leaves are rich deep purple. Z3–8
L. clethroides illus. p.437.
L. congestiflora ‘Outback Sunset’ illus. p.323.
L. ephemerum. Neat, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1ft (30cm). Erect, terminal racemes of star-shaped, grayish-white flowers are borne on slender stems in summer, followed by light green seed heads. Lance-shaped leaves are leathery and glaucous. Z3–8
L. nummularia ‘Aurea’ (Golden creeping Jenny) illus. p.372.
L. punctata (Garden loosestrife) illus. p.243.

LYSIONOTUS

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, creeping, shrubby perennials, grown for their relatively large, tubular, inflated, white to pink flowers. Half hardy. Requires humus-rich, moist but well-drained soil in partial or full shade. Propagate by cuttings in summer or by seed in spring.
L. pauciflorus. Evergreen, suckering, shrubby perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 20in (50cm). Erect, woody stems have ovate, toothed, rigid, leathery, dark green leaves, ¾–1¼in (2–3cm) long, and bear tubular, purple-striped, pale lilac flowers in summer–fall. Z10–11

LYTHRUM

Loosestrife

LYTHRACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals and perennials that thrive by the waterside and in bog gardens. Fully hardy. Grows in full sun or partial shade and in moist or wet soil. Propagate cultivars by division in spring, species by seed, or division in spring or fall. Some species have become noxious weeds in the US.
L. salicaria ‘Feuerkerze’, syn. *L.s. ‘Firecandle’*, illus. p.234. ‘**Firecandle**’ see *L.s. ‘Feuerkerze’*. ‘**Robert**’ is a clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Leaves are mid-green and lance-shaped. Bears racemes of 4-petaled, clear pink flowers from mid- to late summer. Z3–8
L. virgatum ‘Rose Queen’. Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Racemes of 4-petaled, star-shaped, light pink flowers are borne from mid- to late summer above lance-shaped, hairless, mid-green leaves. Z3–8. ‘**The Rocket**’, H 32in (80m), bears slender spikes of red flowers above mid-green leaves in summer. Good for a waterside or bog garden.